

NEHEMIAH

Innocent as a Dove, Wise as a Serpent



HOW THE KINGDOM OF MAN OPERATES

The first will be first

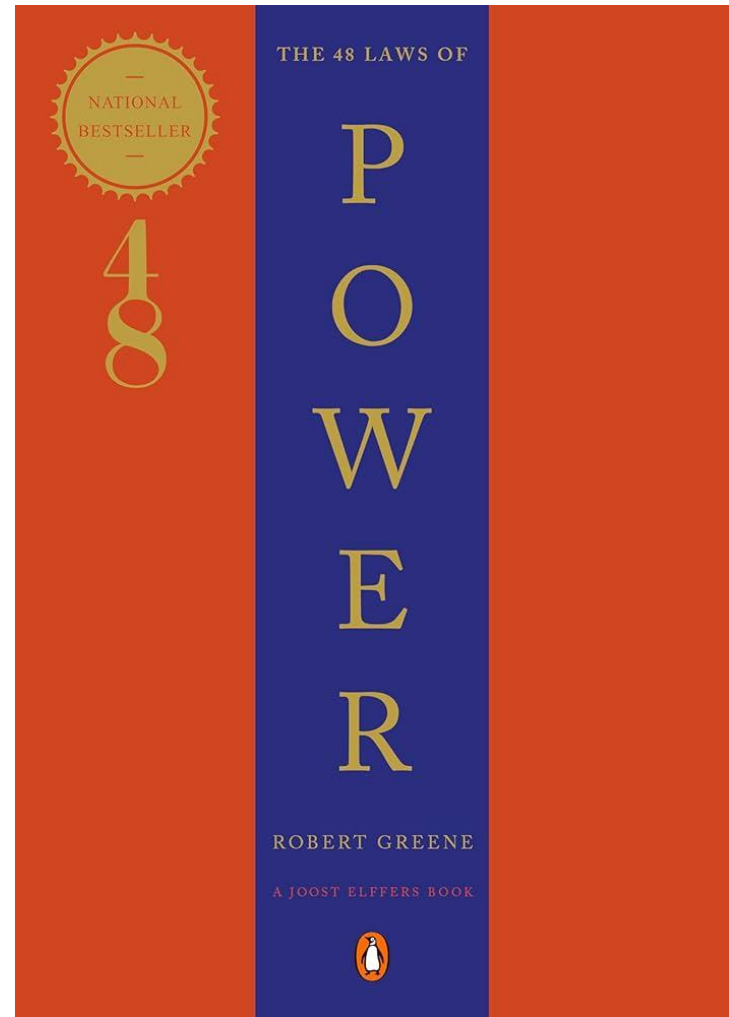
EXAMPLE LAWS

Law 7: Get others to do the work, take the credit

*Use other people's time and energy to finish tasks
while you claim the final prize*

Law 15: Crush your enemy Totally

*Finish off rivals completely in both body and spirit,
because a half-crushed enemy will only recover and
seek revenge*





HOW THE KINGDOM OF GOD OPERATES

The first will be last (Matt. 19:30)

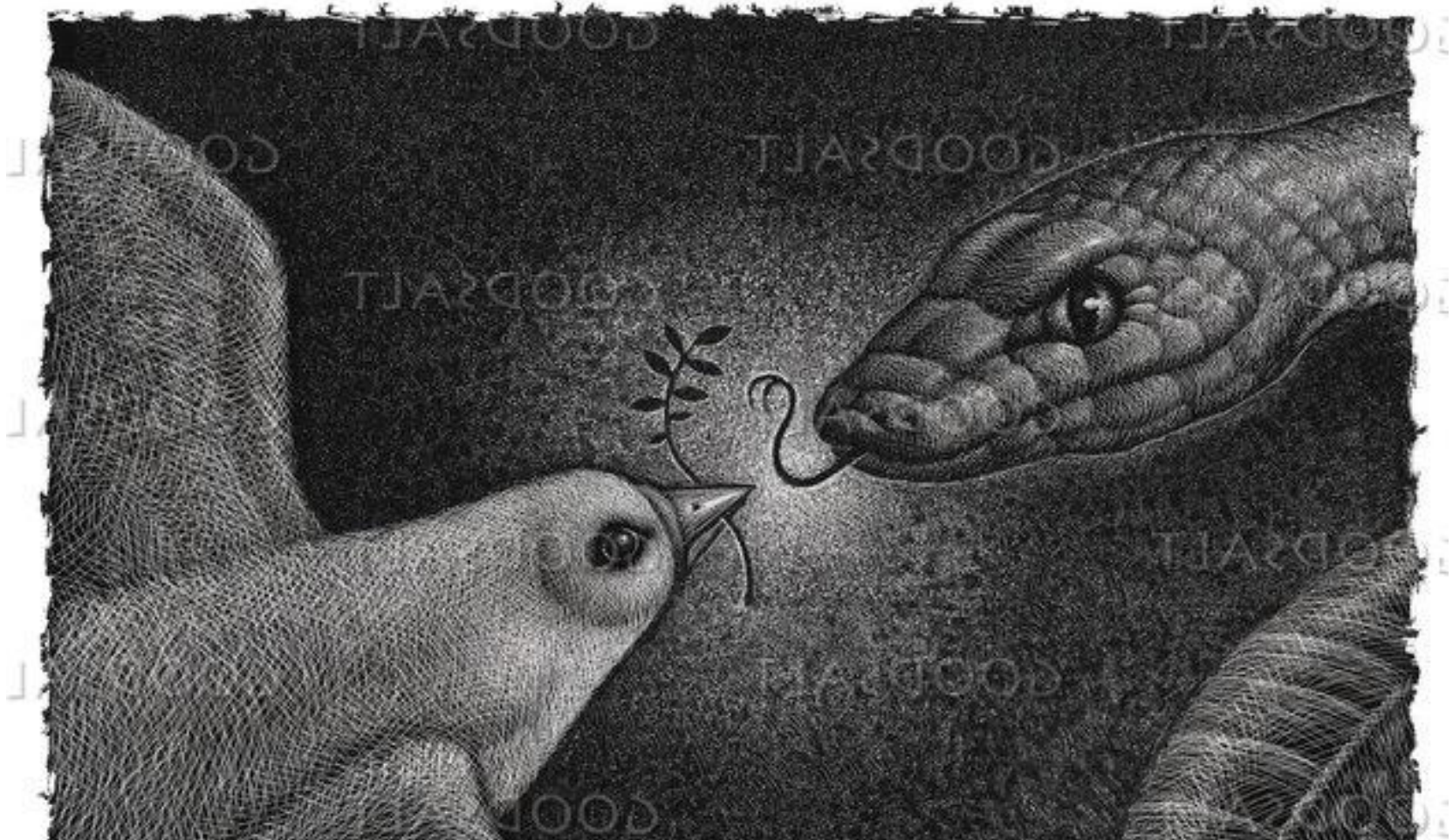
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TWO KINGS

Of Two Opposing Kingdoms



Kingdom of Israel Splits in Two

931 BCE

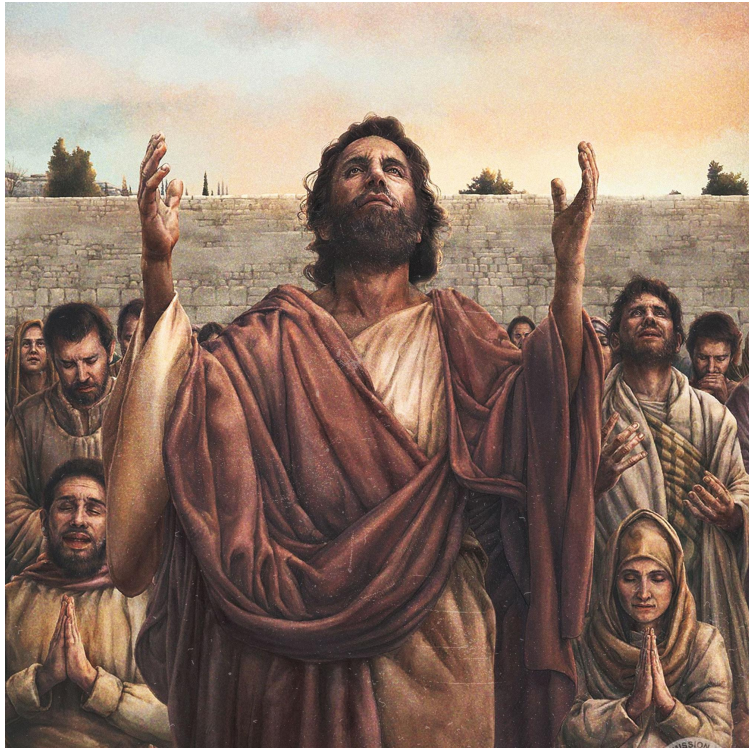
Northern Kingdom of Israel

No good kings, led people into idolatry and sin away from God. Exiled into Assyria ~720 BCE

Southern Kingdom of Judah

Mix of good and bad kings. Some reforms with good leaders, but eventually fell further and further from God. Exiled into Babylon ~586 BCE





Jehoshaphat

*King of Judah and
Citizen of God's Kingdom*

Some highlights

- *Sent Levites out to the people to teach the Law
(2 Chronicles 17:7-9)*
- *Appoints judges across the land to keep the Law
(2 Chronicles 19:5-7)*

Ahab

*King of Israel and
Citizen of Man's Kingdom*

Some lowlights:

- *Promoted idolatry, persecuted prophets*
- *Naboth's vineyard (1 Kings 21)*
- *Follower of 48 Laws of Power before it is written*



Micaiah and the False Prophets

1 Kings 22:5-28



The Ridiculous Disguise

1 Kings 22:29-33



TABLE DISCUSSION

**Are you more of a Dove?
Or a Serpent?**

WOLVES ON THE OUTSIDE



- ~300 years after Jehoshaphat Babylon ransacks Jerusalem, taking Jews into exile
- ~70 years later Persians conquer Babylon and allows Jews to return home
- In Ezra temple is rebuilt, but city and walls in ruins



How big of a problem was this?

- Height: ~20-40 Ft
- Thickness: ~8-12 Ft
- Length: 2.5 Miles
- Some pieces of rubble would be the size of a fridge, weigh as much as a car





Nehemiah

Cupbearer to the King of Persia

- A trusted advisor and confidante of the king (think friendly, wise barkeeper)
- Rubbed shoulders with high level politicians. Established experience with real “wolves”

Who are the wolves?

Sanballat, Governor of Samaria
Tobiah, Governor of Ammon

- Confirmed outside of Bible in the [Elephantine papyri](#)
- Want Israel to be weak (Nehemiah 2:10)
 - *Law 15: Crush your enemy totally*



Some attacks are better off ignored

Nehemiah 2, 4, 6



Don't look for fights, but prepare for them

Nehemiah 4:7-22

St-Takla.org



Best revenge is success

Nehemiah 6:15-16



TABLE DISCUSSION

**Who are the wolves in
your life right now?**

Are you keeping them out?

** Past or Present*

WOLVES ON THE INSIDE





King Artaxerxes

Ruled by the 48 Laws

- First act as king was killing his own framed brother, then the real assassin
- Put down an Egyptian rebellion, killing the leader and quashing it
- Top general revolted and won — Artaxerxes savvy to salvage situation and remain king

Prepared as he expected God to say yes

Nehemiah 2:7-9



Jewish Nobility exploiting Poor

Nehemiah 5:1-11

Wolf Brothers

- 4 economic pressures: Famine, King's Tax, Rebuilding, and Noble's interest
- Estimated 12% interest rate (exorbitant and bad taste)
- Took children as slaves for people who could not pay



Good standing prepared him to deal with directly

Nehemiah 5:12-15



TABLE DISCUSSION

When working with wolves we need to be prepared

**Is there something you are waiting on God for that you
can prepare for?**

**Or is there some sin in your life that will get in the way of
correcting a brother?**

** Past or Present*

CLOSING

